

Main Idea & Key Details

Name:

Date:

ACARA V9.0 — AC9E3LY05: Use comprehension strategies such as summarising and connecting to build literal and inferred meaning.

Learning Intention: I am learning to find the main idea of a text and identify the key details that support it.**Key Idea:** The **main idea** is what a text is mostly about. **Key details** are the small pieces of information that support and explain the main idea.**Warm-Up:** Look at the title "The Busy Beehive". What do you think the main idea of this passage will be?

A. Read the Passage

The Busy Beehive

Bees work together to keep their hive running smoothly. Worker bees fly from flower to flower collecting nectar and pollen. Back at the hive, other bees turn the nectar into honey and store it in small wax cells. Some bees guard the entrance, keeping out unwanted visitors like wasps. The queen bee's only job is to lay eggs, sometimes over a thousand in a single day.

Every bee has an important role, and together they help the whole hive survive. Without teamwork, a beehive could not produce enough honey to last through winter.

B. Find the Main Idea

Circle the best main idea of the passage.

- A) Bees only make honey.
- B) Every bee has a job, and together they help the hive survive.
- C) Wasps are dangerous to bees.

C. Key Details

Write 3 key details from the passage that support the main idea.

.....
.....
.....

D. Main Idea Picture

If you were drawing one picture to show the main idea of this passage, what would you draw? Describe it.

Answer Guide & Extension Activities

Suggested Answers – B & C

B. Answer: B

C. Sample details: worker bees collect nectar and pollen, bees turn nectar into honey, guard bees protect the hive, the queen lays eggs.

Suggested Answers – D

Answers will vary – check the description reflects teamwork within the hive, e.g. bees working together around the hive.

High Five Stars – Self Assessment

★ I read the passage carefully

★ I found the main idea

★ I identified key details

★ I explained my thinking

Extension Activity

Choose another animal that works in a team (e.g. ants, wolves) and write one sentence describing its main 'job'.

Parent/Teacher Tip

Ask 'What is this mostly about?' after reading anything together – a menu, a sign, a story – to build main idea skills in everyday life.

Reflection

How did the key details help you figure out the main idea?
